

CHAPTER 19.

An Act to authorise an increase in the amount of certain payments by County Councils to the County Councils Association. [4th August 1920.]

BE it enacted by the King's most Excellent Majesty, by and with the advice and consent of the Lords Spiritual and Temporal, and Commons, in this present Parliament assembled, and by the authority of the same, as follows :

Increase of
annual sub-
scriptions. ¶
53 & 54 Vict.
c. 3.

1. Section one of the County Councils Association Expenses Act, 1890 (hereinafter referred to as "the principal Act"), which empowers the councils of the administrative counties of England and Wales to pay annual subscriptions to the County Councils Association, shall have effect as if the sum of forty-two pounds was therein substituted for the sum of thirty-one pounds and ten shillings.

Short title.

2. This Act may be cited as the County Councils Association Expenses (Amendment) Act, 1920, and the principal Act and this Act may be cited together as the County Councils Association Expenses Acts, 1890 to 1920.

Application.

3. This Act does not extend to Scotland or Ireland.

CHAPTER 20.

An Act to amend the Acts relating to the Practice of Veterinary Surgery and Medicine. [4th August 1920.]

WHEREAS it is desirable to provide further funds for the Royal College of Veterinary Surgeons to enable it to conduct examinations, prosecutions, and inquiries, authorised by statute, and generally to carry out such other objects or duties as may be considered beneficial to the veterinary profession and necessary for the promotion of the art and science of veterinary medicine and surgery :

44 & 45 Vict.
c. 62.

And whereas doubts have arisen whether persons registered as existing practitioners under section fifteen of the Veterinary Surgeons Act, 1881, are subject to the jurisdiction of the Royal College of Veterinary Surgeons as conferred on them by that Act in respect of persons on the Register of Veterinary Surgeons :

And whereas it is desirable that persons registered as existing practitioners shall be entitled to style themselves veterinary surgeons :

And whereas the profession of veterinary surgeons is not protected from unqualified persons practising as such under the cover of registration under the Joint Stock Companies Acts :

Be it therefore enacted by the King's most Excellent Majesty, by and with the advice and consent of the Lords Spiritual and Temporal, and Commons, in this present Parliament assembled, and by the authority of the same, as follows :

1. This Act shall be supplemental to and read with the Veterinary Surgeons Act, 1881 (herein-after called the principal Act), and the Veterinary Surgeons Amendment Act, 1900, and may be cited as the Veterinary Surgeons Act (1881) Amendment Act, 1920, and shall come into operation on the first day of October one thousand nine hundred and twenty.

Short title
and con-
struction.
63 & 64 Vict.
c. 24.

2.—(1) An annual fee of one guinea shall be payable on the first day of April in each year, or on such other date as the council of the Royal College of Veterinary Surgeons may from time to time determine, by every member of the Royal College of Veterinary Surgeons, save as excepted in subsection (4) hereof, such fee to be paid to the registrar of the Royal College of Veterinary Surgeons on or before the thirtieth day of April, or such other day as the said council may from time to time determine, in each year. On receipt of such fee the registrar shall cause to be posted to the member paying the same a copy of the Register of Veterinary Surgeons free of all cost.

Fees and
exemptions,
with regula-
tions relating
thereto.

(2) If the annual fee of any member shall not have been paid on or before the thirtieth day of April (or such other day as the said council may from time to time determine) in any year, the registrar shall send to such member by registered post at the address given in the Register of Veterinary Surgeons for the time being, or to any other address of which written notice shall have been given by such member to the registrar, a notice requiring payment, and, if such payment shall not be made within one month from posting such notice, a final notice shall be sent to such member by registered post.

(3) If any member of the Royal College of Veterinary Surgeons shall not have paid such annual fee for the time being within one month from the posting of the final notice mentioned in the last preceding subsection, thereupon such unpaid fee shall become and be a debt due and payable to the Royal College of Veterinary Surgeons at the then existing head office of the college, and, if the member so making default be ordinarily resident in England or Wales, may be sued for and recovered in the county court having jurisdiction over the district in which the said member may be ordinarily resident, and, if the member so making default be ordinarily resident in Scotland, such debt may be sued for and recovered in the sheriff court, and, if the member so making default be ordinarily resident in Ireland, such debt may be sued for and recovered in the county court of the district in which the said member is ordinarily resident : Provided always that the council shall have power to withhold

such proceedings for the recovery of the said fee in cases in which, in the opinion of the council, the member is unable to pay. In any such proceedings a certificate purporting to be under the hand of the secretary of the college, setting forth that a member's subscription is due and unpaid, shall be *prima facie* evidence thereof and of a member's default in payment.

(4) This section shall not apply to members of the Royal College of Veterinary Surgeons who do not practise in the United Kingdom, or to holders of the veterinary certificate of the Highland and Agricultural Society who have been or may hereafter be admitted as members of the Royal College of Veterinary Surgeons in conformity with clauses one and two of the supplemental charter of 1879 granted to the Royal College of Veterinary Surgeons, or to existing practitioners as defined in section fifteen of the principal Act.

(5) The council of the Royal College of Veterinary Surgeons shall forthwith prepare and pass byelaws for the disposition of the money from time to time received in respect of the annual fee, and shall have power from time to time to add to, vary, and alter the same (such byelaws, additions, variations, and alterations to be made and carried out subject to the conditions prescribed in the charter of the college dated eighth March eighteen hundred and forty-four): Provided always that such byelaws and any alterations thereto shall have no force or validity until the same shall have been submitted to, and approved by, the Privy Council.

Existing
practitioners
to be entitled
to style
themselves
veterinary
surgeons and
to be subject
to discipline
of Royal
College of
Veterinary
Surgeons.

3. From and after the commencement of this Act, all persons duly registered as existing practitioners, in accordance with section fifteen of the principal Act, and whose names are on the register kept for that purpose, shall be entitled to style themselves veterinary surgeons, and shall be subject to the jurisdiction of the Royal College of Veterinary Surgeons in all respects and in like manner as if they were members of the Royal College of Veterinary Surgeons, and shall be liable in like manner to have their names removed from the register of existing practitioners by the council of the said college, and shall in like manner be bound by any byelaws already made, and which may hereafter be duly made, defining what amounts to conduct disgraceful in a professional respect within the meaning of section six of the principal Act.

Companies to
be liable for
offences the
same as
individuals.

4. Anything which would be an offence under the principal Act if committed by an individual shall be an offence if committed by a company registered under the Companies Acts, 1908 to 1917, or a society registered under the Industrial and Provident Societies Acts, 1893 to 1913.